

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

SU V1 V2 V3 V4



Mostly cloudy 64/57 • Tomorrow: Cloudy, windy 63/42 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, NOVEMBER 15, 2025 • \$4

Trump weighing strikes on Venezuela

High-level talks occur as U.S. forces prepare for possible attack orders

BY DAN LAMOTHE, TARA COPP, MICHAEL BIRNBAUM AND NOAH ROBERTSON

President Donald Trump said Friday night that he has “sort of made up my mind” about how he will proceed with the possibility of military action in Venezuela, following a second consecutive day of deliberations at the White House that included top national security advisers.

Trump’s vague remarks aboard Air Force One were delivered as he traveled for the weekend to his Mar-a-Lago estate in Florida, and included no additional new details. The comments came as U.S. forces in the region awaited possible attack orders and after days of high-level discussions about whether — and how — to strike in Venezuela, according to people familiar with the matter who spoke on the condition of anonymity because the matter is highly sensitive. Joining Trump in deliberations Friday were Vice President JD Vance, Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, Joint Chiefs Chairman Gen. Dan Caine, Secretary of State Marco Rubio and Deputy Chief of Staff Stephen Miller, these people said.

Earlier in the day, an administration official said “a host of options” had been presented to the president. Trump is “very good at maintaining strategic ambiguity, and something he does very well is he does not dictate or broadcast to our adversaries what he wants to

SEE VENEZUELA ON A9

Deportations: Despite war, some Ukrainians may be sent back. **A13**

Ukraine: A corruption scandal is making the E.U. wary. **A13**

Violent attacks on Palestinians threaten the economically important olive crop



HEIDI LEVINE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A vital West Bank harvest in peril

BY LOUISA LOVELUCK

AL-MUGHAYYIR, WEST BANK — For Palestinian farmers in the occupied West Bank, the annual olive harvest has become a time of terror.

Many of those working the fields this fall keep one eye on the road, in case Israeli settlers descend from the hilltops to attack. In one assault, a 54-year-old Palestinian woman was clubbed unconscious. In another, a 50-year-old man was beaten so badly that he was unable to escape his car, which was set ablaze. On Tuesday, two weeks on, he was still in the ICU.

Across 77 towns and villages, according to U.N. figures, gangs of Jewish extremists have burned cars, looted farming equipment and vandalized more than 4,000

SEE WEST BANK ON A12



ZAIN JAAFAR/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

TOP: The Abu Alia family moves fast to gather olives amid a surge in attacks by Israeli settlers. **ABOVE:** Palestinian farmers and Israeli settlers argue.

Federal surge in Memphis lowers crime, raises tension

BY HOLLY BAILEY

MEMPHIS — Since late September, nearly 2,000 state and federal law enforcement officers have surged onto the streets here, helping drive down crime rates. But the crackdown has also sparked tensions in this majority-Black city, with local officials warning of jail overcrowding and racial profiling.

More than 2,100 people have been arrested, and serious crime, including homicides and robberies, has plummeted. Memphis police credit federal agents with helping them find elusive criminals and serve outstanding warrants in a city that has long had one of the highest violent-crime rates in the country. More drivers are renewing their vehicle tags just to avoid being pulled over amid a dramatic increase in traffic stops.

But some city officials and residents describe President Donald Trump’s Memphis Safe Task Force as an “occupation” and are accusing federal agents of purposely targeting Black and Latino motorists. The effort has elevated tensions in this majority-Black city where police have

SEE MEMPHIS ON A7

Chinese supercarrier signals ‘a new era’

The 80,000-ton craft could narrow U.S. superiority in Pacific

BY CHRISTIAN SHEPHERD AND ÁLVARO VALIÑO

China’s efforts to blunt American maritime power in the Pacific, a region the United States has long considered its domain, received a major boost this month with the official launch of its third — and most advanced by far — aircraft carrier, the Fujian.

The 80,000-ton supercarrier, which can accommodate about 60 aircraft and will be accompanied by as many as 10 warships, will dramatically narrow the naval capability gap between the U.S. and China, according to American, Japanese, Taiwanese and Chinese analysts. It will also enable Beijing to further intimidate rivals in the South China Sea and Taiwan Strait.

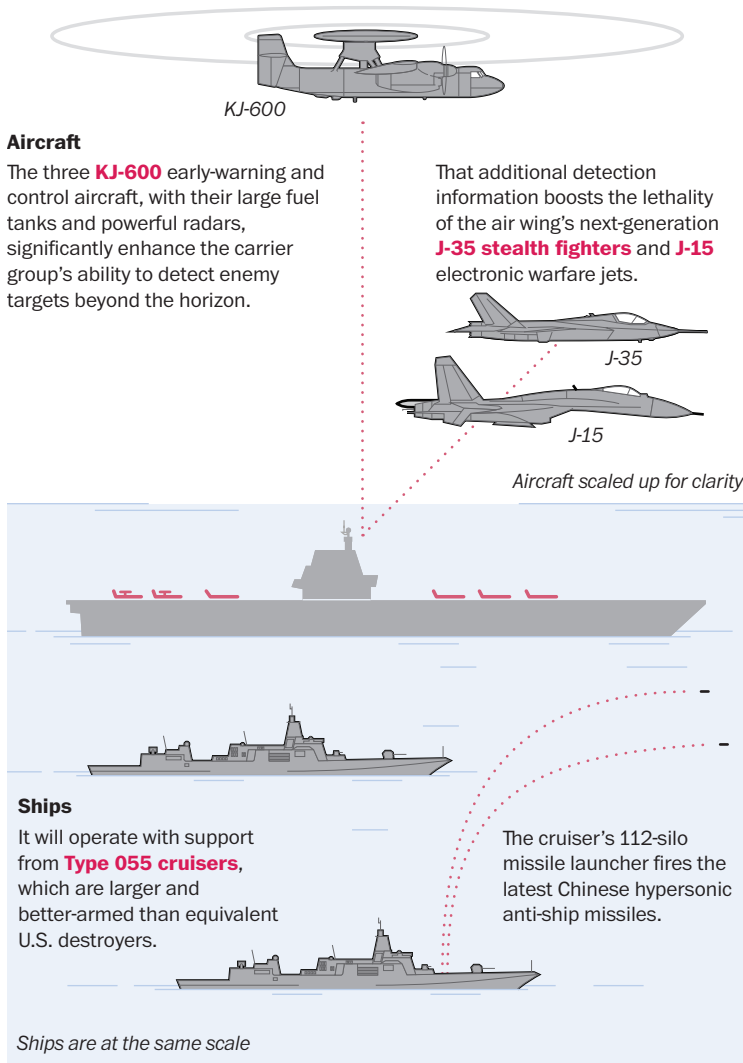
“We’re really entering a new era here,” said Lyle Goldstein, an associate professor at the Naval War College.

China was already a significant adversary: It has the world’s largest navy by number of ships, biggest arsenal of ground-launched ballistic and cruise missiles, and largest active military service, with a standing army of 2 million soldiers.

But China has lagged the United States in aircraft carrier tech-

SEE CHINA ON A10

The Fujian’s improved systems make it a more effective floating command center and airbase capable of operating for long periods far from Chinese shores.



Ships are at the same scale

Upcoming auction of Phillips masterpieces draws backlash

BY SEBASTIAN SMEE

In less than a week, the Phillips Collection will sell masterpieces by Georgia O’Keeffe, Arthur Dove and Georges Seurat at a Sotheby’s auction in New York. Director Jonathan Binstock said funds raised by the sales will be used, for the most part, to commission new works by living artists — but the plan has drawn passionate opposition from some influential supporters of the Phillips and museum members.

The works, which were acquired by museum founder Duncan Phillips and his wife, Marjorie, will be sold at an evening sale on Nov. 20 at Sotheby’s new headquarters, the Marcel Breuer-designed former Whitney Museum building on Madison Avenue.

Sotheby’s estimates the O’Keeffe painting to be worth \$6 million to \$8 million. The Seurat, a drawing in conté crayon, is expected to fetch between \$3 million and \$5 million, and the Dove painting \$1.2 million to \$1.8 million.

“Like many of my museum colleagues,” said Eliza Rathbone, chief curator emerita at the Phillips, “I’m deeply saddened and appalled that the Phillips Collection would so irreparably mar the vision of the founder by selling such carefully chosen works.”

The dispute, which has taken place for more than 18 months



GEORGIA O’KEEFFE FOUNDATION/ARTISTS RIGHTS SOCIETY/PHILLIPS COLLECTION

Georgia O’Keeffe’s “Large Dark Red Leaves on White,” 1925.

largely behind closed doors, came to a head last week. At the 11th hour, the museum’s leadership and the opponents of the sales reached an agreement that will allow the planned sales to go ahead but will restrict future sales from the collection.

The new restrictions relate to which works can and cannot be shed from the collection, a practice known as deaccessioning. According to the previous deaccessioning policy, since 2000, any

SEE PHILLIPS ON A14

IN THE NEWS

Mohammed bin Salman The White House is planning a formal dinner for the Saudi crown prince, marking a dramatic step in his public rehabilitation. **A11**

A mammoth discovery A frozen beast found in Siberia offered a breakthrough in the use of RNA in understanding prehistoric animals. **A2**

THE NATION **Most Americans** say raising children today is unaffordable, a new study concluded. **A2** **The head** of Georgia’s prosecutors board assigned himself a case against the president. **A2**

THE WORLD **New York** Mayor-elect Zohran Mamdani can look to London for lessons from the tenure of Mayor Sadiq Khan, with whom he shares parallels in navigating faith, race and class. **A8**

THE ECONOMY **Trapping people** in unwanted online subscriptions by making it maddening to cancel is illegal, but complaints keep piling up. **A15** **Doug McMillon**, the longtime Walmart CEO who oversaw massive growth, has announced his retirement. **A15**

STYLE **The series** “The Secret Lives of Mormon Wives” is a perfect mirror of our odd cultural moment. **B1**

SPORTS **As the Commanders** get ready to play Miami in Madrid, the NFL aims to keep the language of football from getting lost in translation. **B7**

THE REGION **The former** U-Va. president lashed out at the Justice Department and the school’s board over his departure. **B13** **When the shutdown** halted federal pay, one furloughed worker organized meals for day care staff and first responders. **B13**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A15
COMICS.....B4
OBITUARIES.....B16
OPINION PAGES.....A16
TELEVISION.....B6
WORLD NEWS.....A8

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54401

